

**PROJECT REPORT OF CO-OP Project at Industry (Module-2)**

**ON**

**Burnout in Young Adults: Psychological Causes and Coping Mechanisms**

**submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of degree of**

**BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING**

**In**

**COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING**

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## **DECLARATION**

I hereby certify that the work which is being presented in the project report entitled “**Burnout in Young Adults: Psychological Causes and Coping Mechanisms**” in partial fulfilment of requirement for the award of the degree of Bachelor of Engineering (Computer Science and Engineering) submitted in the department of Computer Science and Engineering at Chitkara University Institute of Engineering and Technology, Chitkara University, Punjab, India, is an authentic record of my own work carried out under the supervision of **Preeti Saini**. The matter presented in this project report has not been submitted in any other university/institute for the award of any degree.

Place: Rajpura

Date: 8th May 2026

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This is to certify that the above statement made by the candidate is correct to the best of my knowledge and belief.

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## **ACKNOWLEDGEMENT**

I would like to express my sincere gratitude to my mentor Preeti Saini and the Department of Computer Science and Engineering at Chitkara University for their valuable guidance and support throughout the completion of this project report.

I am especially thankful for the encouragement and resources provided during the research process. Their continuous motivation helped me successfully complete this study on burnout in young adults and its psychological implications.

I would also like to thank my family and friends for their constant support and encouragement throughout the preparation of this report.

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## **ABSTRACT**

Burnout among young adults has emerged as a major psychological and public health concern in recent years. This project explores the psychological causes of burnout and evaluates effective coping mechanisms among individuals aged 18–30 years. The study synthesizes findings from multiple published studies and reviews the impact of academic stress, occupational pressure, perfectionism, financial anxiety, social isolation, and social media comparison on mental well-being.

The report further evaluates evidence-based coping strategies including Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT), mindfulness practices, physical exercise, social support systems, structured time management, and digital detoxification. Findings suggest that CBT and mindfulness-based interventions demonstrate the highest effectiveness in reducing burnout symptoms.

An Integrated Burnout Assessment and Coping (IBAC) framework is proposed to identify burnout risk and recommend personalized intervention strategies. The report concludes by emphasizing the importance of early psychological intervention, mental health awareness, and institutional support systems for young adults.

# **1. Introduction**

## **1.1 Background**

Burnout is a psychological syndrome characterized by emotional exhaustion, depersonalization, and reduced personal accomplishment. Initially associated with occupational settings, burnout has increasingly become common among young adults due to academic pressure, career uncertainty, financial stress, and digital overload.

Young adults between the ages of 18 and 30 face multiple simultaneous life transitions including higher education, job responsibilities, social expectations, and identity formation. These factors significantly contribute to chronic stress and mental fatigue.

## **1.2 Problem Statement**

The increasing prevalence of burnout among students and young professionals has become a serious concern. Long-term burnout negatively affects productivity, emotional stability, mental health, and quality of life. Despite growing awareness, many young adults remain unaware of effective coping mechanisms and early intervention strategies.

## **1.3 Objectives**

The objectives of this project are:

- To identify the psychological causes of burnout in young adults.
- To study the impact of academic, occupational, and social stressors.
- To analyze evidence-based coping mechanisms.
- To propose an integrated framework for burnout assessment and recovery.

## **1.4 Scope of the Study**

This study focuses on individuals aged 18–30 years and analyzes burnout through published literature, psychological theories, and intervention-based studies. The report covers both causes and coping mechanisms while emphasizing mental health awareness.

## **2. METHODOLOGY**

### **2.1 Research Design**

The project follows a narrative review methodology. Various research papers, journals, and psychological studies published between 1990 and 2024 were analyzed to understand burnout patterns among young adults.

### **2.2 Data Collection**

Research data was collected from reliable academic databases including:

- Google Scholar
- PubMed
- PsycINFO
- Scopus

Relevant keywords used for research included:

- Burnout in young adults
- Emotional exhaustion
- Academic stress
- Coping mechanisms
- Mindfulness and CBT

### **2.3 Inclusion Criteria**

The following criteria were used:

- Participants aged between 18–30 years
- Peer-reviewed studies
- Studies discussing burnout causes or interventions
- English language publications

## 2.4 Proposed Framework

An Integrated Burnout Assessment and Coping (IBAC) framework was proposed. The framework combines:

1. Burnout assessment
2. Identification of psychological causes
3. Personalized intervention strategies

The framework incorporates variables such as emotional exhaustion, social media usage, financial stress, and coping effectiveness.

## 3. Tools and Technologies

The following tools and technologies were used during the preparation of this project:

### Tool / Software Purpose

|                |                      |
|----------------|----------------------|
| Google Scholar | Literature Review    |
| Mendeley       | Reference Management |
| MS Word        | Documentation        |
| NVivo          | Thematic Analysis    |
| SPSS           | Statistical Analysis |
| Excel          | Data Representation  |



## 4. IMPLEMENTATION

### 4.1 Literature Analysis

A total of 25 studies were reviewed and categorized based on:

- Psychological causes
- Burnout prevalence
- Coping strategies
- Intervention outcomes

### 4.2 Identification of Causes

The following major causes of burnout were identified:

- Academic and occupational overload
- Perfectionism
- Social isolation
- Financial stress
- Identity confusion
- Social media comparison

### 4.3 Evaluation of Coping Mechanisms

Different coping strategies were evaluated based on effectiveness:

| Coping Mechanism                   | Effectiveness    |
|------------------------------------|------------------|
| Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT) | High             |
| Mindfulness & Meditation           | High             |
| Physical Exercise                  | Moderate to High |
| Social Support                     | Moderate         |
| Time Management                    | Moderate         |
| Digital Detox                      | Emerging         |

## **5. Major Findings / Results**

The analysis revealed that burnout prevalence is highest among individuals aged 24–26 years due to combined academic, professional, and social pressures.

### **Key Findings:**

- Academic and occupational overload contribute significantly to burnout.
- Perfectionism and self-criticism intensify emotional exhaustion.
- Social media comparison negatively affects self-esteem and mental health.
- CBT and mindfulness-based interventions show the most positive outcomes.
- Combined intervention strategies are more effective than isolated approaches.

## **6. Conclusion and Future Scope**

### **6.1 Conclusion**

This project concludes that burnout among young adults is a multidimensional psychological issue influenced by academic, occupational, financial, and social factors. The increasing demands of modern life and digital exposure significantly contribute to emotional exhaustion and mental fatigue.

Evidence-based coping mechanisms such as CBT, mindfulness practices, physical exercise, and social support systems can effectively reduce burnout symptoms and improve mental well-being.

The proposed IBAC framework offers a structured approach toward burnout assessment and intervention.

### **6.2 Future Scope**

Future work can focus on:

- Conducting longitudinal studies on burnout recovery
- Developing AI-based burnout detection systems
- Exploring burnout in non-Western populations
- Creating personalized digital mental health interventions
- Studying the long-term impact of social media on burnout

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